



Health BY NUM

| By Damayanti Datta |

You are what your numbers are. 0-5-10-25 is the quickest way to sum you up: 0, if your life is tobacco free, 5 for servings of fruits or veggies, 10 for walking 10,000 steps (or 30 minutes of aerobic activity) and 25 for keeping your body mass index below that cut off. That's just to start you off. The route to good health is paved with serious number crunching: is your cholesterol less than 200 (the good HDL over 60, bad LDL below 100 and the ugly triglyceride less than 150)? Do you have a healthy blood pressure of 140 over 90? Is your blood sugar score less than 100 after an eight-hour fast? Check if you have a healthy grip of 25-30 kg to beat osteoporosis. Is our thyroid level a healthy 0.4-5? Your heart attack risk factor over 20 per cent? It can be daunting to keep up, and doctors say too few of us track the numbers that add up to good health.

That tracking is usually done by medics, who put people through a battery of tests and drills, listen to their lungs, run ECGs to test their hearts, order MRIs if they see something suspicious. But can individual lives be used to arrive at a larger truth? The Apollo Hospitals Group certainly thinks so. Over the last decade, the Health and Lifestyle Unit (HLU) has been monitoring the health check-up data of clients. The result—a study of 1,16,731



REJEN SINGH

11% drop in number of urban Indians eating out more than twice a week in the last 10 years

54% have issues with their weight, perceived or real, and **48%** are trying to lose weight constantly



Graphics by MADHUMANGAL SINGH

15% surge in diet-savvy consumers in urban India in the last 10 years

— 2000-04 — 2005-09

Welcome fall in high fat intake

36%

26%



Healthy drop in sugar intake

34%

23%



WEIGHT WATCHERS

